Those involved in pro-Khalistan and anti-India activities today are doing exactly what I had predicted in my meeting with Director (R) Gary Saxena on 8 June 1984. I had also spoken about the possibility of such things happening in February-March 1990, when I told B. Raman that the R&AW white paper that he had presented was full of white lies. The gist of my prediction in both those instances was that two parallel external influences would be working in earnest to encourage pro-Khalistan persons, organizations and associations. The main force was the Pakistan's ISI, for reasons stated earlier, and the second were some Western countries such as the US, Canada and the UK.

These countries would normally not do anything to contain or curb anti-India activities in view of the growing Sikh electorates in certain constituencies where they could influence the election results at the federal or national level. And to justify their inability to restrain pro-Khalistan and anti-India activities, they would continue emphasizing their constitutionally enshrined values of freedom of speech, freedom of association and so forth. There are, however, other ways of controlling such activities, if these countries so desired. But they would only be inclined to do so if their respective commercial or collective geopolitical interests were being served in some way.

As far as the collective geopolitical interests of the Western countries led by the US are concerned, the rise of China and its increasing economic, military and political clout as a parallel superpower is causing significant concern to them. These countries will do everything possible within their means to ensure that India is on board to contain China's rise. If India chooses to join them, then it is possible that pro-Khalistan elements may be asked to remain dormant for the time being.

There are quite a few examples of such issues being shifted to the backburner by the Western countries when it suited their geopolitical interests to do so. One example is that of Tibet, which was kept on the back burner when US President Richard Nixon's February 1972 visit to China ushered in a new era of relations between the US and China, and effectively removed China as a Cold War foe to allow the US to concentrate its efforts on the